

2. **Number of fan installation mounts:** More the number of fans, better the cooling. But you cannot install a fan if there's no support. Cabinets can have dust filters and cutouts on all sides to let you install fans. With those, you can skip a liquid cooling system if you're low on budget.
3. **Dimensions:** You just bought the world's most powerful graphics card but then you discover that it doesn't fit in the cabinet. Always make sure that the components being attached to the motherboard directly (PCIe cards, CPU coolers, etc.) are not bigger than what your cabinet can



A good cabinet allows you to reduce clutter

accommodate. Look for the length of these cards, height of CPU coolers and the clearance in their particular areas in the cabinet.

Two rather significant attributes which can skip your attention are build quality and cable management. If the case is of low build quality and can accumulate rust over time, you are in for some trouble. At the same time, if it is heavy, you are going to have a tough time moving the cabinet. A sturdy

cabinet full of high-end components can go upwards of 20 kg). That's a heavy thing to move around. Though a PC is supposed to stay where it is placed for long time, you might need to move it around for cleaning dust, adding/removing components etc.

If the case allows you to open both left and right side panels, there is a good chance, it allows you to manage cables efficiently. Cable management leads to cleaner installation and easy upgradation and maintenance. Such cases allow you to hide the extra cable lengths underneath the motherboard thus ensuring near-perfect airflow. You can read about cable management in more detail in Chapter 14.

Last but not the least, a beautiful looking case wouldn't hurt anyone. A good-looking case is always better than a vanilla rectangular box sitting atop your table or on the ground. You might need to add RGB LED fans or light strips to make it look even better but the case itself looking sexy is a bonus point any day. **d**